Vanessa Bonanno

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Located in Italy, EU citizen, open to relocation

Meticulous and perceptive UX/UI Designer with 2,5+ years in enterprise and public-sector digital products who believes good design starts with deeply understanding people. At SMC (DGS Group) I have designed 6 web platforms for B2B, banking and government clients and delivered 12+ WCAG 2.1/2.2 audits for 7 organisations, documenting 1000+ findings tested with NVDA, VoiceOver. I turn research and audit results into design systems, high-fidelity UI and developer-ready specs, and I teach Figma and accessibility to client teams.

Experience

UX/UI Designer at SMC (DGS group) **Udine, Italy | January 2024 - Present**

- Designed 6 web platforms end to end on Liferay DXP and SAP-based stacks: a B2B dealer portal (parts catalogue, checkout, warranty claims) for a €700M industrial group, the homepage and dashboards of a national PNRR funding platform, and a real-time fleet-diagnostics dashboard for an industrial group.
- Delivered 12+ WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA accessibility audits for 7 clients (PagoPA, Ministry of Culture, Costa Crociere, Banca Sella, IVASS, DGS and SMC enterprise intranets), documenting 1000+ prioritised findings and re-testing fixes with developers across 3 confirmation rounds.
- Bilingual accessibility statement (Italian Law 4/2004, EN 301 549) for cruise line's onboard web app.
- Ran usability tests and a tree-testing studies (198 nodes, 675 items) to restructure an IT service catalogue for a consumer-credit bank.
- Built a bilingual design-system foundation (Figma variables, modes, accessible components) and internal "Accessibility in Figma" guidelines adopted by the design team.
- Taught Figma course to a client team and a 5-day video-editing module to 23 students at ITS Lazio Digital.
- Benchmarked AI-assisted auditing against manual testing (24 vs 8 findings) to define where automation fits in the audit workflow.

Research assistant at CNR - ISPC **Florence, Italy | July 2023 - December 2023**

- Research Fellow: User Design and Analysis of colour-related collaborative virtual experiences aimed at strengthening social cohesion and cultural heritage stewardship.
- Co-authored Chromatic Visions: publications available at vanessabonanno.github.io/myportfolio/resume.html
- Contributed to Brancacci POV, a digital storytelling project for scientific dissemination and inclusive heritage accessibility.

Research assistant at Aalto University **Helsinki, Finland | March 2022 - May 2022**

- Research Assistant for SPICE, in collaboration with Design Museum Helsinki contributing to the development of VR Pop-up Museum (Pop-up-VR Museum paper), scanning the museum collection, conducting ontology development and metadata management for digital heritage assets.

Before 2022

- Artisan managing the full production cycle of artisan gelato. From laboratory preparation to customer service and daily operations, working both independently and as part of a small team for 7 years.
- Event coordinator and manager: directed end-to-end operations for We will Rock & Blues annual music festival in Campoformido. Supervising logistics, live performances, and F&B services while coordinating a team of local volunteers (35 people).

Skills and Tools

- **Design**: information architecture, qualitative and quantitative user research, usability and tree testing, user flows, wireframing and high-fidelity prototyping, design systems and component libraries (tokens, variables, modes), responsive design, heuristic evaluation, design-to-dev handoff covering edge cases and breakpoints.
- **Accessibility**: WCAG 2.1/2.2 and EN 301 549 audits, WCAG-EM methodology and AgID guidelines, screen reader testing (NVDA, VoiceOver, TalkBack), axe, WAVE, Siteimprove, ARIA DevTools, PDF accessibility, accessibility statements.
- **Tools**: Figma (advanced, FigJam, Make and Sites), Penpot, Liferay DXP, Material Design, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, VSCode, Bootstrap, GitHub, Jira, Miro, Notion, Slack.
- **AI**: AI-assisted workflows, prompt engineering for UX/UI, AI-assisted heuristic evaluations, rapid prototyping with LLMs (Claude, Claude Design, Gemini, Figma AI), Pen.dev, testing AI skills for accessibility.
- **Video and audio**: Adobe Premiere, Ableton, CSound.

Education

Master's degree in Digital Humanities and Digital Knowledge at University of Bologna · 108/110	2020 - 2023
Bachelor's degree in Multimedia Science and Technology at University of Udine, IT · 106/110	2016 - 2020
ESABAC Diploma, Italian-French title, Liceo C. Percoto, Udine	2010 - 2015

Languages

Native Italian · English fluent, daily working language · French fluent · German basic

Courses and Certifications

- English Assessment Result - OLS, Erasmus+, B2 level, 2022
- AccessibleEU Italy, certificate of participation, 2026
- Accessibility Days, certificates of participation, 2025 e 2026
- Accessible Design for UX/UI Designers, Liz Brown, Udemy, expected end: Oct 2026

I authorize the processing of personal data contained in this CV pursuant to D.Lgs 101/2018 and EU Regulation 2016/679 (GDPR).